

5 Expert-Approved Ways to Fight Your FOMO

1 Shut down social media. (Duh.)

If you want to post something, that's fine, but stop scrolling through your feed, says Christine Hassler, millennial expert and author of *Expectation Hangover*. "If there's someone you compare yourself to a lot, turn off notifications for their updates," she suggests. "Be in charge and remove opportunities where fear of missing out can happen."

Need a little extra help? Try an app like Freedom that blocks access to the sites you want (ahem, Instagram), when you want, across all your devices.



2 Think charitably.

Every time you feel a wave of FOMO coming on, think of someone else. "Stop obsessing over yourself and look up," says Kay Wills Wyma, mom of five and author of *I'm Happy for You (Sort Of ... Not Really): Finding Contentment in a Culture of Comparison*. "There's likely a person in your life who could use a little attention or assistance, so focus your energy on being helpful to others instead of worrying about what you do (and don't) have yourself."

Volunteer at your local community garden, walk dogs at the pound, or deliver food for Meals on Wheels. Bonus: Your kid can help with these activities, too.



3 Adjust your expectations.

If you feel like you're missing out on something specific, figure out a way to have something similar. For example, if you always skip happy hour with colleagues because you need to get home to the kids, set a lunch date instead so you can socialize in peace while the kids are in school, suggests Hassler.



5 Perfect a skill for your own gain.

FOMO is such a waste of precious time that goes too fast, especially when you're parenting, says Wyma. Instead of caring about others, use that energy to concentrate on being your own best self. To that end, make a list of things you always thought you'd like to try, and the next time you find yourself feeling jealous of someone else, try tackling one.

If taking up a new hobby feels too daunting right now, divert your attention to one hobby you already know you enjoy and when you feel a wave of FOMO coming on, work on mastering it.



4 Practice mindfulness. (My favorite and constant goal.)

The next time your mind wanders to what you want and can't have, focus on your immediate surroundings. "Smell a flower, listen to the birds, hug your kids," says Hassler. "The more you're present, the less you experience FOMO."

[EDIT NOTE:] If you're open to trying meditation, I cannot say enough about Headspace. It's incredible.

Gratitude also goes a long way towards mindfulness. To practice it, Hassler suggests making a list of three to five simple things you're grateful for every night before you go to bed. "Again, focus on what you have so you'll focus less on what you're missing," she said.

For a more physical and immediate method, Hassler likes the rubber band trick. "I tell people to wear a rubber band around their wrist, then, when they're mentally going to a place that isn't useful, they snap the band and snap themselves back to the moment," she said. Ouch. But does seem like it might work!

